

HINDENBURG DISASTER

DEADLY SPARK

On May 6, 1937, the Hindenburg, on approaching its mooring mast in Lakehurst, New Jersey, suddenly burst into flames and fell from the sky. This dramatic photograph shows the fireball rising high above the tail of the airship as it sinks to the ground. No one knows for sure what caused the tragedy, but the most likely suspect is a spark from a buildup of static electricity igniting the flammable skin.



SOARING OVER MANHATTAN

The LZ 129 Hindenburg flies over Manhattan's famous skyline. At this time only the rich could afford airship travel. A one-way trip over the Atlantic could cost as much as a new car. A round-trip fare was equivalent to the cost of an average house.

"It's burning, bursting into flames... this is one of the worst catastrophes in the world... Oh, the humanity, and all the passengers screaming around here!"

HERBERT MORRISON

RADIO REPORTER WITH CHICAGO'S WLS

